

Prof. Dr. Lincy Pyl and Selection Committee
Department of Mechanics of Materials and Constructions (MeMC)
Vrije Universiteit Brussel

Subject: Motivation letter – PhD candidate, Mechanics of Materials and Constructions (M²S)
Introduction video: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/14s-V07z3fopEllnUP8vmMJPMxQW57mg9/view>

Dear Prof. Pyl and Selection Committee,

I am Pooja Awasare, a civil and environmental engineer, and I am applying for the PhD position in Mechanics of Materials and Constructions at VUB. Materials and structures have stayed with me since my civil engineering studies, and I want to take that interest into doctoral research with your group.

During my Diploma and Bachelor's in Civil Engineering in India I spent many hours in the materials laboratory with concrete, steel, soil, aggregates and water. From those labs I learned to stay with a result and keep checking until I understood what had caused it. That same way of working is still with me.

I later completed a Master's in Environmental Engineering at HTW Dresden. My thesis looked at how construction teams can manage projects and use resources more carefully, and that work brought me back to materials and structures as the heart of building and of sustainable practice.

In Belgium I worked with a construction partner on circular practices in day-to-day project delivery. That role showed me how waste, reuse and process are handled on real projects, and it strengthened my wish to go deeper into the mechanical behaviour of materials and structures through laboratory testing and careful analysis.

I have been following MeMC and reading about your group's work, including Prof. Pyl's research on lightweight structures and on the mechanical performance of materials, where experiments are linked with analytical and numerical models, and MeMC's work on resource-efficient and circular building systems.

Thank you for considering my application and for watching my introduction video.

Yours sincerely,

Pooja Awasare